

Contribution to Specification Development Policy

Version 1.0

Effective 2026-06-08

Endorsed by TSIG Group

1. Purpose

This policy defines the governance, roles, and procedures for developing, maintaining, and publishing the FDOF architecture specification. It ensures transparent collaboration, reproducible versioning, and consistent quality control across all contributors.

2. Scope

Applies to all participants who create, discuss, or modify any part of the FDOF architecture specification, including but not limited to:

- Core editorial team members
- Technical Specification and Implementation Group (TSIG) members
- External contributors from other interested parties

3. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Permission	Responsibilities
Anyone	Create Issues, Fork the repository, Submit Pull-Requests	Initiate discussions, propose changes, and follow the contribution workflow.
Editor	Approve or reject Pull-Requests	Review code and documentation quality, ensure compliance, and provide feedback within the defined time-frame.
TSIG	Resolve Issues, set priorities, define critical aspects	Oversee the overall roadmap, mediate disputes, and approve final releases.

4. Repository Structure

Main Branch

- Holds the released, version-tagged specification
- No direct commits
- Changes arrive via development branch that have passed editorial approval

Development Branch

- Serves as the integration branch for accepted Pull-Requests
- All new features, fixes, and enhancements are merged here before a release

Other

Feature-Branches and Forks are created upon request and need.

5. Contribution Workflow

1. **Issue Creation:** Any participant may open an Issue describing a problem, enhancement, or discussion topic. The Issue must contain a clear title, description, and, where applicable, references to related specifications or external resources.
2. **Fork & Development:** Contributors fork the repository (or create a feature branch) after the Issue has been opened. All code or documentation changes must reference the originating Issue (e.g., `Fixes #123`).
3. **Pull Request Submission:** A Pull-Request is opened against the development branch and must include:
 - a. A link to the associated Issue.
 - b. A concise summary of the changes.
 - c. Any required documentation updates.
4. **Editorial Review**
 - a. At least **two** Editors must review and explicitly approve the Pull-Request.
 - b. Review comments must be addressed before approval.
 - c. Editors shall respond to a PR within 14 calendar days of submission.
 - d. If a PR is not addressed within this period, the submitter may request escalation to TSIG.
5. **Merging**
 - a. Once the required approvals are obtained, the Pull-Request is merged into the development branch.
 - b. A release tag is created on the ****main**** branch after a coordinated release cycle, following semantic versioning.

6. Issue Resolution

Issues serve as the primary discussion platform; decisions, alternatives, and rationales must be documented therein.

- All Issues are discussed during the monthly TSIG-meeting.
- TSIG members assign a responsible party, set priorities, and record decisions in the meeting minutes.

7. Disclaimer

This policy is a living document and may be refined as the contributor base grows. Revisions of this policy require approval by TSIG.